



Request For Information (RFI) for Oracle User Productivity Kit (UPK) Replacement Effort

Notice ID: RFI-DEAMS-UPK-2026-01

ABSTRACT

The United States Air Force, Defense Enterprise Accounting and Management System (DEAMS) Program Management Office, is issuing this Request for Information (RFI) to identify Commercial-Off-the-Shelf (COTS) solutions capable of replacing the Oracle User Productivity Kit (UPK). The DEAMS program requires a modern Digital Adoption Platform (DAP) to provide in-application training and performance support for its Oracle-based financial management system, which serves over 26,000+ users across 170+ installations.

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Part I: General Information

- **Notice ID:** RFI-DEAMS-UPK-2026-01
- **Issuing Agency:** United States Air Force, Air Force Materiel Command (AFMC), Air Force Life Cycle Management Center (AFLCMC), Defense Enterprise Accounting and Management System (DEAMS) Program Management Office (PMO)
- **Date of Issuance:** Thursday, 26 February 2026
- **Response Due Date:** Monday, 30 March 2026 5:00 PM EST
- **Primary Point of Contact (POC):**
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- **Primary NAICS Code: 513210 (Software Publishers).** Identified for most appropriate as core requirement is for a pre-packaged, subscription-based COTS software product.
- **Secondary NAICS Codes: 611420 (Computer Training)** if offering emphasizes training service aspect, or **541519 (Other Computer Related Services)** if solution is part of a broader, integrated services contract. The DEAMS PMO & Contracting Office will make the final determination on NAICS code utilized.

Part II: Introduction and Purpose

This is a Request for Information (RFI) issued by the US Air Force Defense Enterprise Accounting Management System (DEAMS) Program Management Office for market research purposes, in accordance with the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Part 10.

This is not a Solicitation, Request for Proposal (RFP), or Request for Quotation (RFQ).

The Government is not obligated to award a contract or otherwise pay for the information provided in response to this RFI. Any information submitted by respondents is voluntary.

The purpose of this RFI is to identify Commercial-Off-the-Shelf (COTS) solutions capable of replacing the Oracle User Productivity Kit (UPK) tool, which is nearing its end-of-life and is no longer supported by the original manufacturer. The Air Force seeks to understand the marketplace of available Digital Adoption Platforms (DAPs), which are software layers that guide users and facilitate proficiency on underlying applications. Therefore, the goal is to find a modern, sustainable solution that provides robust content authoring, management, and in-application user support while adhering to stringent Department of War cybersecurity and supply chain security mandates.

The Government intends to use the information gathered from this RFI to inform the PMO of a future acquisition strategy. This approach allows the Government to consider non-cost factors, such as technical merit, past performance, and management approach, and weigh them against a comprehensive Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) to select a solution that provides the best overall value to the Air Force.

Part III: Background

The Defense Enterprise Accounting and Management System (DEAMS) is a critical financial management system for the U.S. Air Force and U.S. Transportation Command (USTRANSCOM). It is based on the Oracle E-Business Suite (EBS) platform and serves a diverse user base of approximately 26,000+ individuals across 170+ geographically dislocated locations. The system also interfaces with approximately 40 other systems, creating a complex operational environment.

In accordance with DoD Instruction (DoDI) 5200.44, a criticality analysis has identified DEAMS and its supporting components as mission critical. Therefore, any replacement solution must meet a high standard of security and supply chain resilience. The RFI in this platform is intended to be as scrutinous as possible.

The DEAMS program utilizes an Agile SAFe development methodology, which results in frequent software updates to the program itself and the need for a training solution that can keep pace. Currently, the program uses Oracle UPK to develop, deploy, and maintain a large library of training materials, including an extensive pre-built content library for Oracle EBS. As Oracle has placed the UPK tool in a “sustaining support” status, the DEAMS program must identify and implement a replacement solution to ensure continuity in user training, onboarding, and ongoing performance support. At a minimum, the DAP must

provide exportable documents (e.g., .DOC, .PPT, .PDF) for users to reference via a catalog library of work aids. Optionally, the replacement solution can also be a DAP that can overlay on top of the enterprise application, providing real-time, in-app guidance and contextual support to users directly within their workflow. Overall, a successful DAP implementation is to support the expected increase of overall user productivity.

Part IV: Statement of Need / Desired Capabilities

The Government is seeking a COTS solution with the following key capabilities. Respondents should indicate their ability to meet, or not meet (e.g., "Fully Compliant," "Partially Compliant," "Not Compliant," or "On Roadmap"), these desired capabilities which are tailored for a complex, agile government environment.

The information derived from Part IV will be utilized in "Attachment 1 – Capability Matrix."

1. Content Authoring & Development:

- **No-Code Content Creation:** A user-friendly editor that allows non-technical personnel to rapidly create and update guidance without needing to write code.
- **Multi-Format Recording:** Ability to record user interactions with web-based applications (specifically Oracle EBS) and desktop applications to automatically create simulations, step-by-step instructions, and videos.
- **Rich Content Editing:** An intuitive editor that allows authors to easily add, edit, and format content, including annotations, callouts, masking of sensitive data (PII), and branching logic.
 - **Note for Emphasis:** Oracle UPK offers a library catalog capability where hierarchy of job aid creations are connected and updated automatically (e.g., a "parent-child" link).
- **Multiple Output Formats:** Ability to publish content to various formats from a single source recording, including interactive simulations, printable documents (e.g., .PDF, .DOCX), presentation slides (e.g., .PPT), or other formats (e.g., .HTML) for Learning Management System (LMS) integration.
 - **Note:** Interaction with output format should also allow users to interact with output (i.e., select/deselect graphical images)
- **Localization and Translation:** Tools to support the translation of content into different languages.

- **UPK Content Migration:** Describe the solution's capability to migrate existing content from Oracle UPK. This includes the availability of automated conversion tools to protect the Government's investment in existing content, support for a hybrid migration approach (automated conversion followed by manual enhancement), or professional services to facilitate the transition.
 - **Note:** Oracle UPK utilizes the .ODARC file type that necessitates a conversion.

2. Agile Content Lifecycle Management & Governance:

- **Centralized Content Library:** A secure, centralized repository for storing, versioning, and managing all training and support content.
- **Agile Content Lifecycle Support (DevSecOps Integration):** Capabilities that align the DAP's content lifecycle with the ERP's development cycle. This must include:
 - **Version Control for Content:** The ability to treat DAP content as code, allowing it to be stored and managed in a version control system to track changes and manage different versions of guidance.
 - **CI/CD Pipeline Integration:** The ability to integrate with a DevSecOps toolchain to automate and synchronize content deployment with ERP software updates.
 - **Testing in Non-Production Environments:** The ability to create and test content in isolated sandbox/staging environments alongside ERP updates before pushing to production.
 - **Automated Change Detection & Testing:** Tools that can automatically detect when UI changes in the underlying application have broken existing guidance and support automated testing of content as part of the CI/CD process.
- **Role-Based Access Control & Workflow Management:** Ability to define granular permissions for content authors, reviewers, and administrators, and features to support a collaborative content lifecycle with peer review and approval workflows.
- **Content Reusability:** Ability to reuse content snippets across multiple training modules and perform bulk updates when the underlying application changes.
 - **Note:** Oracle UPK utilizes Reusable Content Objects (RCO) automatically link objects. I.e., a “one to many” relationship model

3. Content Delivery & End-User Experience:

- **In-Application Guidance:** The ability to deliver real-time, context-sensitive guidance directly within the live Oracle EBS application. This includes interactive walkthroughs, tooltips, checklists, and field validations.
- **User Segmentation and Targeting:** The ability to deliver different guidance to different user roles, groups, or site-specific workflows to improve usability.
- **Cross-Application and Desktop Support:** The capacity to provide a unified guidance layer across a diverse technology stack, including web-based applications (Oracle EBS), custom systems, and on-premise desktop applications, to support the entire user workflow.
- **AI-Powered Assistance:** Artificial intelligence capabilities to power a self-help knowledge base, provide predictive analytics, and offer intelligent, conversational help to reduce the burden on help desks.
- **Proactive Change Management:** Tools to create in-app announcements, pop-ups, and guided tours to inform users about software updates and process changes.

4. System & Technical Requirements:

- **Hosting:** Preference for a solution that has achieved or is on a clear path to achieving FedRAMP Moderate or High authorization for cloud hosting (SaaS). Please specify if on-premises or private cloud options are also available and detail the authorization timeline.
- **Integration:** Proven, stable integration with Oracle E-Business Suite (Forms and OAF pages) and modern web applications.
- **Scalability and Performance:** Demonstrated ability to support a large, enterprise-wide user base (26,000+ users) across 170+ geographically dispersed locations without degrading ERP system performance.
- **Analytics and Reporting (KPIs):** Comprehensive dashboards to track user behavior and measure success. The analytics must provide measurable insights into the Agile development cycle and support ROI metrics. This includes tracking:
 - **User Adoption/Engagement KPIs:** User onboarding completion rates, time to first transaction, feature adoption rates, and First Contact Resolution (FCR) rates for support.

- **Productivity/Performance KPIs:** Task completion rates, reduction in user errors, time to proficiency, and Mean Time to Resolution (MTTR) for issues.
 - **ROI KPIs:** Data to quantify reduced training costs and a reduction in support ticket volume.
- **Sandbox and Simulation:** The ability to create an interactive, risk-free replica of the live application to support hands-on training and User Acceptance Testing (UAT) without impacting the production environment.

5. Security, Compliance, and Supply Chain Risk Management (SCRM):

- **FedRAMP & CMMC:** Information on the solution's current FedRAMP status (e.g., In-Process, Authorized) and at what impact level (Low, Moderate, High). Additionally, provide information on your solution's Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification (CMMC) status.
- **DoW Compliance:** Ability to meet DoW security requirements, including DISA STIGs and support for authentication via Common Access Card (CAC) / Public Key Infrastructure (PKI).
 - **Note:** If no STIG is available, please provide any Vendor Security Guide or “best practices” your provided solution has.
- **Accessibility:**
 - **Section 508 of the Rehabilitation Act:** Requires federal agencies to make their electronic and information technology accessible to people with disabilities, ensuring they have comparable access to information and data as people without disabilities.
 - **Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA):** Requires state and local governments to make their websites and mobile applications accessible to people with disabilities by conforming to the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1 Level AA.
- **Secure Software Development Lifecycle (SSDLC):** Identify if the solution was developed in accordance with government-specified secure software development practices as available for industry designated by Executive Order 14028. This includes adherence to frameworks like the NIST Secure Software Development Framework (SSDF), SP 800-218.
- **Software Bill of Materials (SBOM):** The vendor must have the capability to generate and provide a comprehensive SBOM in a standard format (e.g., SPDX, CycloneDX).

- **Statutory & Regulatory Compliance:**
 - **Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.204-25:** The solution and vendor must be in full compliance with Section 889 of the 2019 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA).
 - **FAR 52.204-23:** The solution must also be free of any hardware, software, or services from Kaspersky Lab.
 - **Section 1260H List (NDAA FY 2021):** Prohibited "Chinese Military Companies" The Department of War maintains a list of "Chinese Military Companies" (CMCs). The most recent version of the CMC list can be found in the Federal Register. Please reference the DoW release here:
<https://www.war.gov/News/Releases/Release/Article/4023145/dod-releases-list-of-chinese-military-companies-in-accordance-with-section-1260/>
 - **Supply Chain Transparency:** The vendor must demonstrate transparency regarding its supply chain, including providing information on foreign ownership, control, or influence (FOCI) and maintaining provenance data for all software components.
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Part V: Information Requested from Respondents

Please structure your response to address the following sections.

Section A: Company Information

1. Company Name, Address, and Website.
2. Point of Contact (Name, Title, Email, Phone).
3. UEI Number and CAGE/DUNS Code.
4. Business Size Status (e.g., Small Business, 8(a), Woman-Owned, etc.).
5. Existing Government contract vehicles (e.g., GSA MAS, NASA SEWP, NIH CIO-SP3, Alliant 2, or other applicable DoW or USAF APL/EPL) that include your solution.
6. Past Performance of Organization, to include:
 1. Point of Contact (Name, Title, Email, Phone).
 2. The last 3 contracts implemented with the Federal Government.

Section B: Solution Overview

1. Product Name and Version.
2. Provide a brief functional description of your solution.
3. Describe the solution's architecture (e.g., SaaS, private cloud, on-premise).
4. Describe the typical implementation and onboarding process and timeline for an organization of our size.

Section C: Security, Compliance, and SCRM Questionnaire

Please provide detailed responses to the following questions to demonstrate your security posture and SCRM practices.

1. *Corporate SCRM Program:*

- Describe your corporate SCRM program, its governance structure, policies, and the roles of those who manage it.
- What methodologies and standards (e.g., NIST SP 800-161, ISO 27036) does your SCRM program follow?
- Describe your process for assessing and monitoring the risk of your own sub-tier suppliers.

2. *Compliance and Governance:*

- Provide a statement of compliance with Section 889 of the 2019 National Defense Authorization Act. Describe the processes you have in place to ensure prohibited equipment is not used.
- Confirm that your products do not include any hardware, software, or services developed or provided by Kaspersky Lab or its affiliates, in accordance with FAR 52.204-23.
- Confirm that your products do not fall under the Section 1260H List (NDAA FY 2021) for Chinese Military Companies.
- Describe your company's foreign ownership, control, or influence (FOCI) status.

3. *Secure Software Development (EO 14028):*

- Provide a self-attestation that your organization conforms or does not conform with the secure software development practices outlined in the NIST Secure Software Development Framework (SSDF), SP 800-218.

- Describe your secure software development environment, including how you employ automated tools to maintain a trusted source code supply chain and ensure code integrity.
- Describe your capability to generate and provide a Software Bill of Materials (SBOM) for your product in a standard, machine-readable format (e.g., SPDX, CycloneDX). Additionally, how does your organization and solution utilize SBOMs to monitor for new vulnerabilities?
- Describe how you maintain provenance (historical) data for all internal and third-party software components.

4. *Vulnerability and Incident Management:*

- Describe your process for identifying, tracking, and remediating vulnerabilities in your software and its third-party components.
- Provide a copy of your incident response plan, specifically addressing supply chain-related incidents, and describe your procedures for notifying customers. The plan should include details on requiring a corrective action plan to address root causes of failures.

5. *Artifacts and Documentation:*

- Please provide a list of available/releasable artifacts that can be provided, such as your corporate SCRM Policy, third-party security assessments (e.g., NIAP, FIPS 140, SOC 2), or a mapping to NIST SP 800-53 controls.

Section D: Past Performance & Experience

1. Provide 1-3 examples of your company's *experience* implementing your solution for other Federal Government (particularly DoW) or large commercial organizations (10,000+ users) to support an ERP system (Oracle, SAP, etc.) within an Agile development environment. Please describe the scope of the implementation.
2. Describe your company's management approach for supporting large programs, including project management methodology, quality assurance, and risk mitigation strategies.
3. Describe your company's experience and partnership model for supporting large programs, including the availability of a dedicated customer success team or center of excellence.

Section E: Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM) Pricing

1. Provide a Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM) price for your solution to facilitate a comprehensive Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) analysis. This ROM is for budgetary and planning purposes only and will not be considered a binding offer.
2. Describe your pricing model (e.g., per user/per month, perpetual license, subscription). Please include any tiered pricing structures based on user count, feature sets, or compliance levels.
3. Please provide an estimated cost breakdown for a 26,000+ user environment, separating costs into the following TCO categories:
 - Initial Costs (Acquisition & Deployment):
 - Subscription/License Fees (for the initial term).
 - Implementation, Configuration, and Setup Fees.
 - Data Migration Costs (from Oracle UPK).
 - Integration Costs (with Oracle EBS and other systems).
 - Customization Costs.
 - Initial User Training.
 - Ongoing Operational Costs:
 - Recurring Subscription/License Fees.
 - Annual Maintenance/Support Fees (if not included in subscription).
 - Upgrade Costs (for new modules or major versions).
 - Ongoing Training Costs.
 - Indirect & Hidden Costs:
 - Describe how your solution helps mitigate indirect costs such as internal IT personnel overhead, productivity loss during transition, and change management efforts.
 - Long-Term/Retirement Costs:
 - Describe any costs associated with data extraction upon contract termination.

4. Describe available options for Enterprise License Agreements (ELAs) and multi-year contracts, including any potential discounts.
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Part VI: Response Instructions

1. Responses should not exceed 20 pages (excluding cover page and table of contents).
 2. Please submit your response in PDF format.
 3. Complete “Attachment 1 – Capability Matrix” found under the SAM.gov attachments.
 4. Submit your response via email to the POC & Alternate POC listed in Part I no later than the Response Due Date. The subject line of the email should read: "Response to RFI-DEAMS-UPK-2026-01 - [Your Company Name]".
 5. Any questions regarding this RFI must be submitted via email to the POC. The Government may, at its discretion, post questions and answers for all interested parties.
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Part VII: Disclaimers

- The Government will not reimburse respondents for any costs associated with the preparation or submission of a response to this RFI.
 - Responses to this RFI are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government to form a binding contract.
 - Information submitted in response to this RFI may be shared with Government support contractors for the purpose of evaluation. Respondents should identify any proprietary information in their submission.
 - This RFI is issued for the purpose of determining market capabilities and does not constitute a commitment, implied or otherwise, that DEAMS PMO will take procurement action in this matter.
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Executive Summary

This effort addresses the need to replace the Oracle User Productivity Kit (UPK) tool as the current training and performance support tool for the mission-critical Defense Enterprise Accounting and Management System (DEAMS). Given that UPK is nearing end-of-life, the program faces an operational risk to the proficiency of its 26,000+ users across the Air Force. The objective is to conduct a market analysis and procure a modern Commercial-Off-the-Shelf (COTS) Digital Adoption Platform (DAP) that provides continuous, in-application training and contextual support directly within the user's workflow.

The immediate course of action is to issue a comprehensive Request for Information (RFI) to identify capable industry partners. This RFI is specifically tailored to the DEAMS program's agile nature, requiring a solution that can integrate with a DevSecOps framework and keep pace with frequent software updates under its Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe) methodology. Key evaluation criteria will focus on the information delineated in Part IV: Statement of Need / Desired Capabilities.

This procurement is strategically focused on mitigating risk and ensuring long-term value for the Department of War. The RFI embeds stringent cybersecurity and Supply Chain Risk Management (SCRM) criteria, mandating vendor compliance with FedRAMP, CMMC, and key federal statutes to protect the system and its data. By leveraging a best-value tradeoff analysis against a comprehensive Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) model, this initiative will ensure the selection of a secure, sustainable, and cost-effective solution that enhances user proficiency, reduces operational support costs, and maximizes across five key areas of note for capabilities: *Content Authoring & Development, Agile Content Lifecycle Management & Governance, Content Delivery & End-User Experience, System & Technical Requirements, and Security, Compliance, and SCRM.*

The RFI is structured to align with federal acquisition best practices and has been significantly enhanced to address the realities of the DEAMS program, which operates in an Agile SAFe development environment. It begins by providing clear guidance on the most appropriate primary NAICS code, **513210 (Software Publishers)**, to attract relevant vendors. The DEAMS PMO & Contracting Office will make the final determination on NAICS code utilized. It provides essential background on the DEAMS program, noting the system's mission-critical nature and large scale to justify the heightened security and performance scrutiny.